PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Cupping Therapy

Suction and times in [brackets] follow your training, your cup maker and the client. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No bleeding disorder, blood thinners, active cancer, pacemaker or fever.

CHECK

Pregnant: no cups on abdomen or low back. Varicose veins, thin skin, sunburn: avoid area.

PRE-SESSION SENT

Eat a light meal first. Plan for visible marks for [3–10] days after the session.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Cups disinfected, log signed ☐ Cups inspected, no cracks ☐ Pump and valves working ☐ Oil in pump, nut-free option ☐ Fresh linens, cradle cover ☐ Hands washed, timer set

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult & screen**	5 min	Confirm health changes, medications and goals. Agree on areas.
2	**Consent & photos**	3 min	Consent signed. Explain marks. Before photos only if client agrees.
3	**Skin check**	2 min	Good light. Skip moles, lesions, new tattoos and broken skin.
4	**Warm up**	5–10 min	Massage the area with oil to warm tissue and gauge pressure.
5	**Test cup**	1 min	One cup on a fleshy area, light suction. Ask how it feels.
6	**Static cups**	[5–10] min	Light to moderate suction. Check skin and comfort every few minutes.
7	**Gliding cups**	[5–10] min	Well-oiled skin, low suction. Glide slowly along muscle, never over bone.
8	**Release**	2 min	Press the skin beside the rim to break the seal. Never pull a cup off.
9	**Settle**	5 min	Light strokes over cupped areas. Wipe off excess oil. Keep client warm.
10	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Sit up slowly. Review sheet and card. Rebook once marks have faded.

CUP CARE

Soap and water first, then EPA-registered disinfectant, full label contact time

Every client

Wash, rinse, disinfect for [ ] min per the cup maker, then air dry.

End of day

Clean pump, valves and case. Store cups dry and covered.

Inspect

Discard cups with cracks, chips, tacky silicone or weak suction.

Log it

Date, cup set and initials for every clean. Keep [ ] years.

Endpoint: even marks, client comfortable, no blisters or broken skin. **Safety:** no fire cupping [policy] and no wet cupping (outside massage scope). Keep cups off endangerment sites, large vessels, nerves and bony areas.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Sharp pain, tingling or numbness: release now.
- Blister: release, don't pop it, clean dressing.
- Dizzy or faint: remove all cups, lay client flat.
- Cup stuck: press skin at the rim; never pull.
- Broken skin: gloves, gauze, bag waste, disinfect.
- Raise legs, offer water, sit up only when ready.

Chest pain, trouble breathing or fainting that doesn't pass: call 911. Write an incident report.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Cup set · sizes	Areas cupped	Static · gliding	Suction · minutes
Skin response	**Client feedback**	**Cups cleaned · log**	**Next visit · initials**